

Academic Writing (BETA)

Seminar 5



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Today

- ▶ Conclusions

- ▶ Punctuation



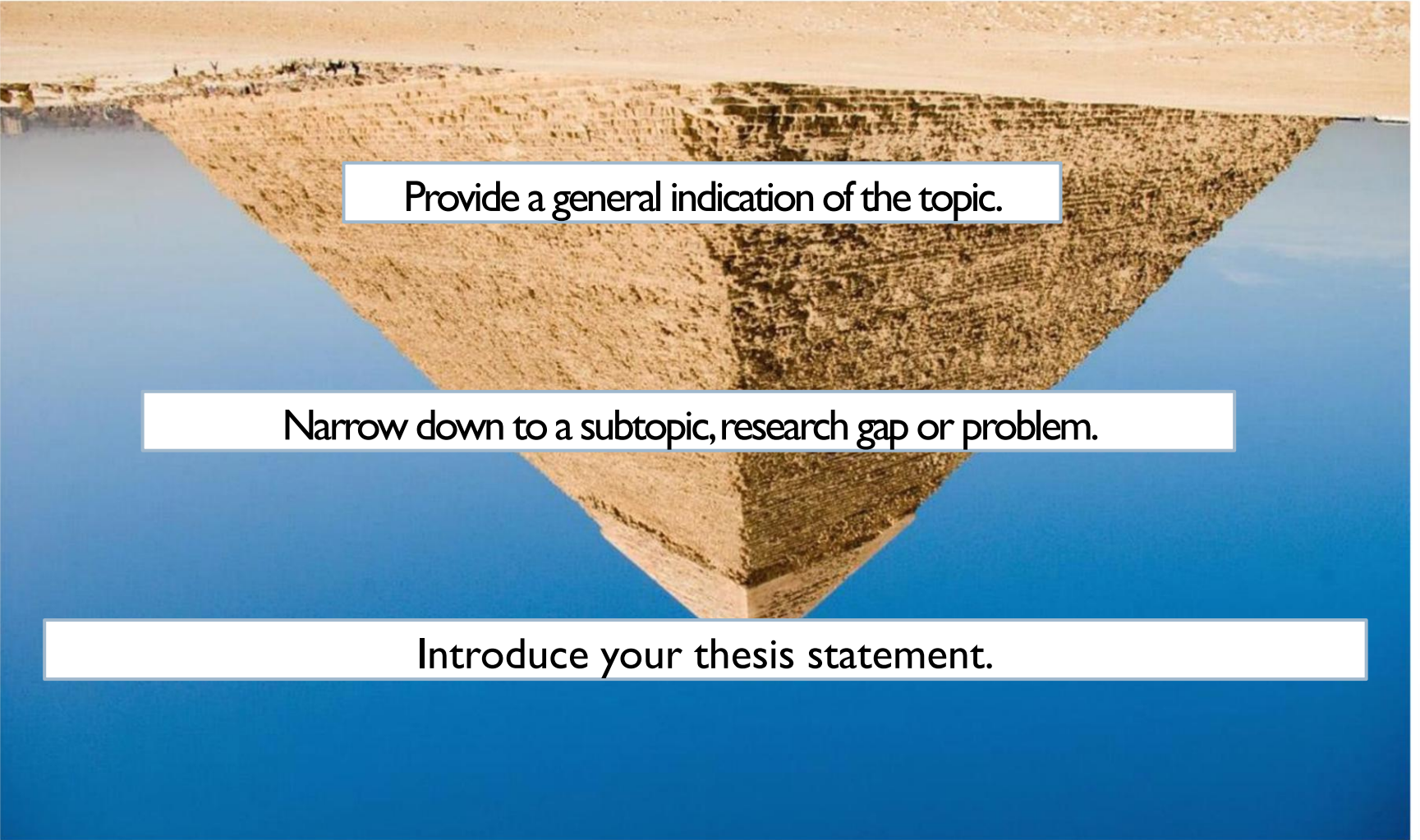
How to write a conclusion

- a. Remind the reader of/recap the **thesis statement**
- b. **Synthesize your findings** to answer the main question in your thesis statement
- c. Provide an **outlook**, so broaden up the topic again, either by
 - i. Discussing the **implications** of the current findings;
 - ii. And/or providing specific **suggestions** for further research

Your **final conclusion** should consist of **a single paragraph** (roughly 200 words).



How to write an introduction in 3 steps



Provide a general indication of the topic.

Narrow down to a subtopic, research gap or problem.

Introduce your thesis statement.

Introduction

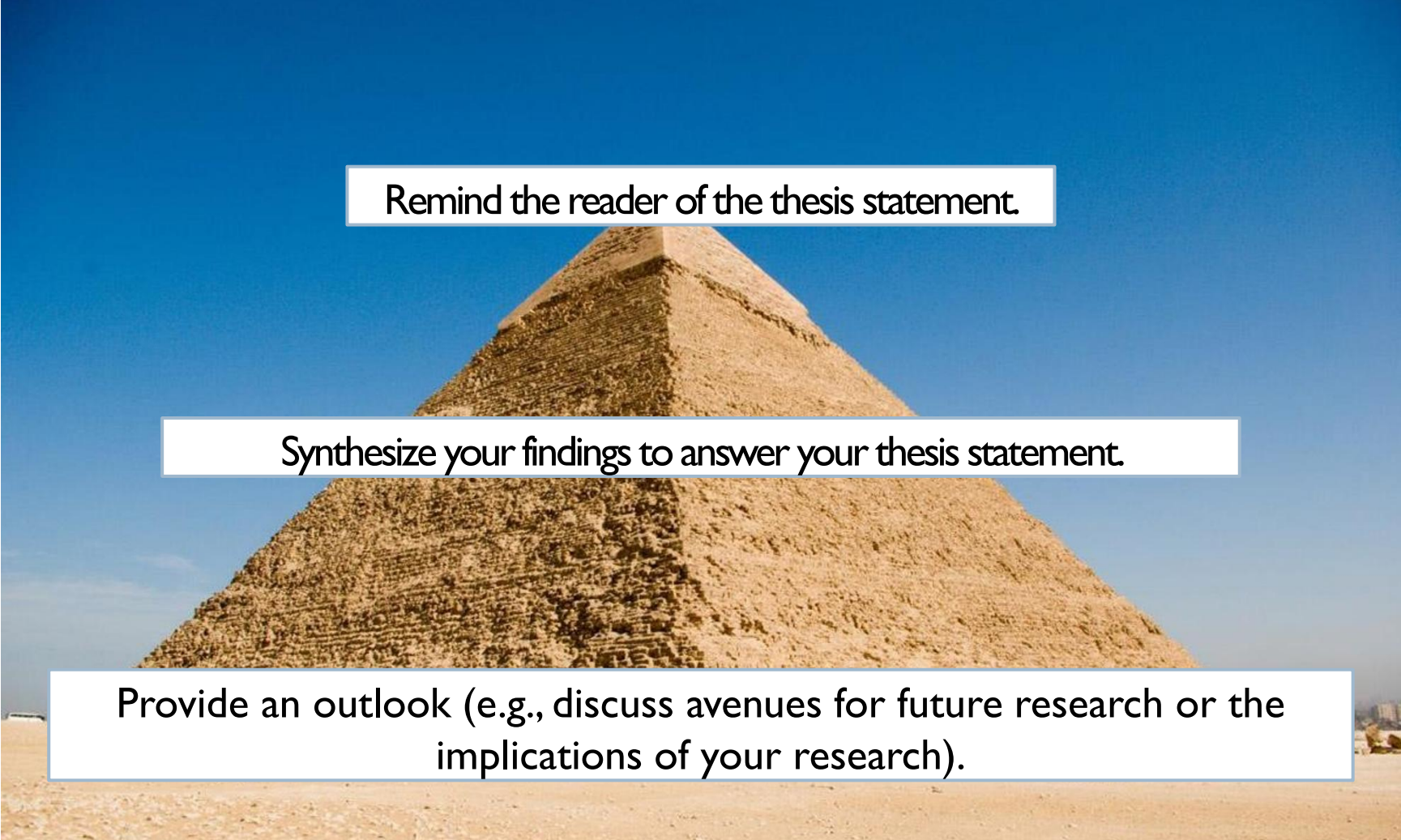
Former colonial powers regularly face scrutiny for their mass collection of artifacts acquired through oppressive colonization.

Scholars like Wintle [1] have explored the relationship between museums and decolonization, while others like Scott [2] have advocated for collaborative approaches between past colonial powers and their former colonies.

This essay aims to analyze the arguments presented by both scholars concerning colonial artifacts.



How to write a conclusion in 3 steps

A large, ancient pyramid, likely the Great Pyramid of Giza, stands in a sandy desert under a clear blue sky. The pyramid is constructed from light-colored stone blocks, showing some weathering and erosion. The perspective is from a low angle, looking up at the pyramid's apex.

Remind the reader of the thesis statement.

Synthesize your findings to answer your thesis statement.

Provide an outlook (e.g., discuss avenues for future research or the implications of your research).

Conclusion

This essay aimed to analyze the arguments presented by Wintle [1] and Scott [2] concerning colonial artifacts.

Both authors underscore that without cooperation with former colonial territories, Western museums risk glorifying imperial pasts.

Their arguments highlight the need to ensure museums are used to educate visitors rather than perpetuate outdated ideologies.

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Axis

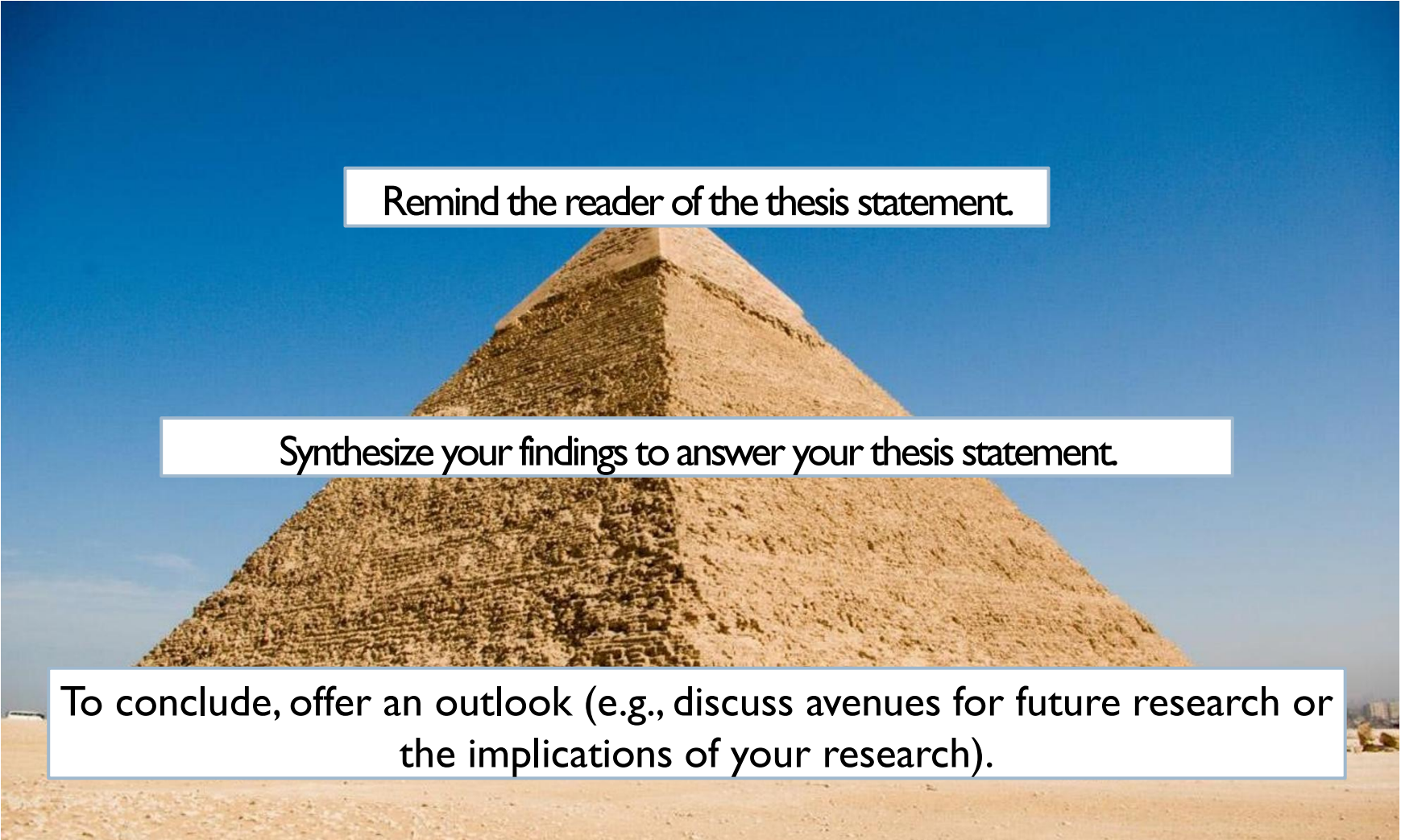
The title, thesis statement, topic sentences and conclusion together form the axis of a text.

If one or more parts of the axis are missing or do not fit well with the others, the overall coherence of the text suffers.

One common problem in student writing is that the conclusion does not answer the thesis statement.



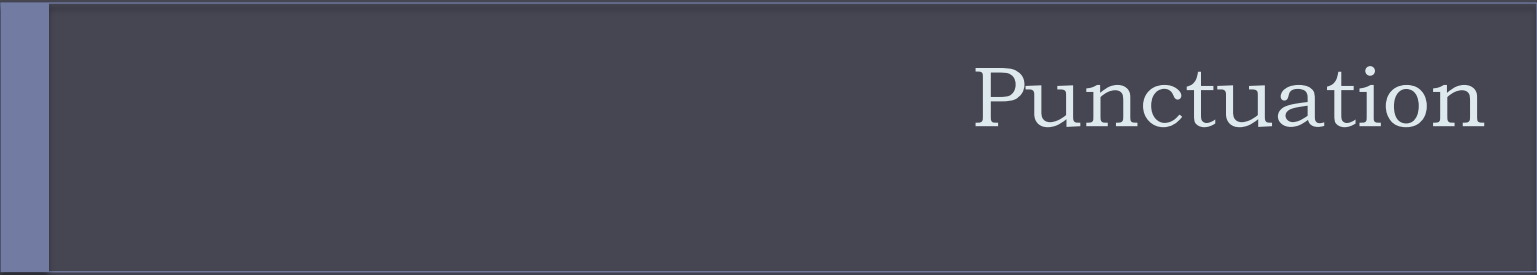
Handout: conclusions

A large, ancient pyramid, likely the Great Pyramid of Giza, stands in a desert landscape under a clear blue sky. The pyramid is constructed from light-colored stone blocks, showing some weathering and erosion. The foreground is a flat, sandy desert floor.

Remind the reader of the thesis statement.

Synthesize your findings to answer your thesis statement.

To conclude, offer an outlook (e.g., discuss avenues for future research or the implications of your research).

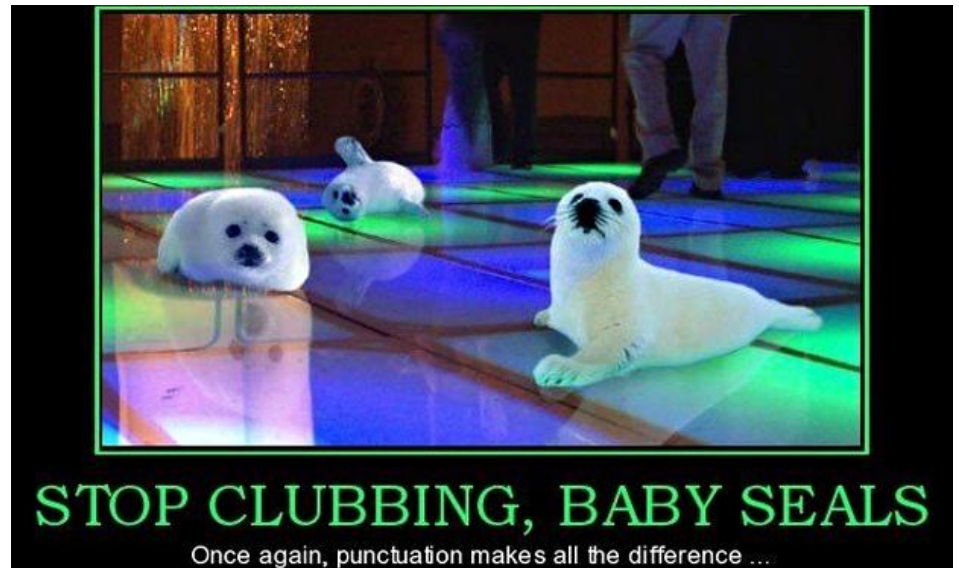


Punctuation

Today's Programme



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Punctuation Quiz

Question 1

- A. My first job in a factory involved the manufacture of escalator handles and ketchup bottle lids.
- B. My first job in a factory involved the manufacture of escalator handles, and ketchup bottle lids.



Question 1

A. My first job in a factory involved the manufacture of escalator handles and ketchup bottle lids.

~~A. My first job in a factory involved the manufacture of escalator handles, and ketchup bottle lids.~~



Question 2

- A. Ms. Espinoza has offered to coach the team this year, however, the competition for the job is intense.
- B. Ms. Espinoza has offered to coach the team this year, however the competition for the job is intense.
- C. Ms. Espinoza has offered to coach the team this year; however, the competition for the job is intense.



Question 2

- ~~A. Ms. Espinoza has offered to coach the team this year, however, the competition for the job is intense.~~
- ~~B. Ms. Espinoza has offered to coach the team this year, however the competition for the job is intense.~~
- C. Ms. Espinoza has offered to coach the team this year; however, the competition for the job is intense.**



Question 3

- A. My favorite teacher, who just happens to be my uncle, retired from the university last summer.
- B. My favorite teacher who just happens to be my uncle, retired from the university last summer.
- C. My favorite teacher, who just happens to be my uncle retired from the university last summer.



Question 3

- A. My favorite teacher, who just happens to be my uncle, retired from the university last summer.**
- ~~B. My favorite teacher who just happens to be my uncle, retired from the university last summer.~~
- ~~C. My favorite teacher, who just happens to be my uncle retired from the university last summer.~~



Question 4

- A. Given the hard choices our coach has had to make this year it's no wonder she's decided to retire.
- B. Given the hard choices our coach has had to make this year, it's no wonder she's decided to retire.



Question 4

- ~~A. Given the hard choices our coach has had to make this year it's no wonder she's decided to retire.~~
- B. Given the hard choices our coach has had to make this year, it's no wonder she's decided to retire.**



Question 5

- A. Believing in her own skills and possessing a supreme confidence, proved to make the difference in her campaign.
- B. Believing in her own skills and possessing a supreme confidence proved to make the difference in her campaign.



Question 5

- ~~A. Believing in her own skills and possessing a supreme confidence, proved to make the difference in her campaign.~~
- B. Believing in her own skills and possessing a supreme confidence proved to make the difference in her campaign.**



Question 6

- A. My favorite pizza combinations are sausage peppers and onions mushrooms extra cheese and anchovies and hamburger sun-dried tomatoes pepperoni and sliced red potatoes.
- B. My favorite pizza combinations are: sausage, peppers, and onions, mushrooms, extra cheese, and anchovies, and hamburger, sun-dried tomatoes, pepperoni, and sliced red potatoes.
- C. My favorite pizza combinations are sausage, peppers, and onions; mushrooms, extra cheese, and anchovies; and hamburger, sun-dried tomatoes, pepperoni, and sliced red potatoes.



Question 6

- ~~A. My favorite pizza combinations are sausage peppers and onions mushrooms extra cheese and anchovies and hamburger sun-dried tomatoes pepperoni and sliced red potatoes.~~
- ~~B. My favorite pizza combinations are: sausage, peppers, and onions, mushrooms, extra cheese, and anchovies, and hamburger, sun-dried tomatoes, pepperoni, and sliced red potatoes.~~
- C. My favorite pizza combinations are sausage, peppers, and onions; mushrooms, extra cheese, and anchovies; and hamburger, sun-dried tomatoes, pepperoni, and sliced red potatoes.**
-



Punctuation: some basics

-
- ▶ Because that is the rule.
 - ▶ However, the decision is not always easy.
 - ▶ After reading this memo should be burned.
 - ▶ In the summer of 1995 (,) we went to Paris.
 - ▶ After he had looked at the menu, he decided he wasn't hungry.
 - ▶ It was cold, it was raining.
 - ▶ He says that: "Frank is stupid".
 - ▶ He says that "Frank is stupid".
 - ▶ The reason is: the lack of focus.
 - ▶ The options are: x, y, and z.
 - ▶ The options are as follows: x, y, and z.
-





-
- ▶ Full stop
 - ▶ End of sentence
 - ▶ Needs to come at the end of a complete sentence
 - ▶ You have be on time. Because that is the rule.
 - ▶ Follows the reference
 - ▶ It was not the case (Jones 1992).



,

- ▶ Comma
- ▶ Separates two parts of a sentence, or helps the reader
 - ▶ After reading this memo should be burned.
 - ▶ After reading, this memo should be burned.
- ▶ Should not separate ...
 - ▶ the subject and the verb (e.g., the student who got the award, studied eight hours a day)
 - ▶ the verb and the object (e.g., It is even more interesting when you consider, that several species act the same way)
- ▶ In some cases obligatory, in some cases optional,
 - ▶ However, the decision is not always easy.
 - ▶ In the summer of 1995(,) we went to Paris.
 - ▶ After he had looked at the menu, he decided he wasn't hungry.
- ▶ Cannot join or separate two sentences:
 - ▶ ~~It was cold, it was raining.~~

,

- The Oxford (or serial) comma is the final comma in a list of things.
- *Please bring me a pencil, an eraser, and a notebook.*

**Come meet Janet,
a clown, and an acrobat.**



**With
Oxford Comma**

**Come meet Janet,
a clown and an acrobat.**



**Without
Oxford Comma**

YOUR
DICTIONARY

,

Restrictive and non-restrictive relative clauses

- ▶ Dogs, who bark, don't bite.
- ▶ Dogs who bark don't bite.

- ▶ The students who were late were punished.
- ▶ The students, who were late, were punished.



-
-

-
- ▶ Colon
 - ▶ Announces or introduces
 - ▶ What comes before it needs to be a complete sentence.
 - ▶ The options are: x, y, and z.
 - ▶ The options are as follows: x, y, and z.
 - ▶ Use with care.
 - ▶ He says that: “Frank is stupid”.
 - ▶ He said: “Frank is stupid”.
 - ▶ The reason is: the lack of focus.
-



How to use a semicolon

The most feared punctuation on earth

Created by The Oatmeal

<http://theoatmeal.com>



“ Using a semicolon isn’t hard; I once saw a party gorilla do it. ”

<http://theoatmeal.com/comics/semicolon>

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;

- ▶ Semicolon
 - ▶ In-between separating and joining two sentences
 - ▶ The parts of the sentence before and after the semicolon need to be grammatically complete
 - ▶ Does not have the announcing/introducing function of the colon
 - ▶ Separates longer items in a list
-



?

- ▶ Question mark
- ▶ Don't use direct questions in essays (or max. 1).



!

-
- ▶ Don't use exclamation marks in essays!



“X”

- ▶ Double quotation marks
- ▶ Use for quotations only.
- ▶ Make sure they are formatted correctly, opening vs closing quotation marks: “....”
- ▶ Do not use two single quotation marks to make double quotation marks: “brb”



,

- ▶ Apostrophe
 - ▶ Don't use apostrophes for contractions (because contractions are not allowed)
 - ▶ Don't use apostrophes for plurals: hobbies, not hobby's
 - ▶ Do use apostrophes to show possession:
 - ▶ Romeo's feelings
 - ▶ Not: the feelings of Romeo
 - ▶ Not: Romeo his feelings
-



Exercise 2 - handout



Exercise A: AI help with punctuation

Nineteenth-century historians (in Western Europe and North America) dealt largely with governments and great men, and with the development of national consciousness and the growth of political liberalism; twentieth-century historians, more interested in economic and social democracy, have turned towards economic and social history, towards peoples, and away from individuals. Traditionally, historians in the western countries were interested only in their own civilization, seeing the rest of the world, if at all, in terms of interaction with Western culture.



Assignment 3

Write a 3-sentence conclusion to your final essay according to the format we discussed. Make sure you use the checklist that will be made available on Canvas.

The assignment will be graded on the following aspects:

- Structure: format of the three-sentence conclusion.
- Academic style: appropriate level of formality and the use of academic idiom.
- Linguistic range and accuracy: grammar, vocabulary, and punctuation.

If you get a fail, you will need to hand in a new version within a couple of days.



Next week

In our final session, we will discuss your text plans and formality.

